

TWENTY-FOURTH NORTHERN MARIANAS COMMONWEALTH
LEGISLATURE
IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

SESSION, 2026

H. Res. 24-31

A HOUSE RESOLUTION

To congratulate, honor, and pay tribute to the Saipan Chamber of Commerce on the occasion of its Golden Jubilee, marking fifty (50) years since its incorporation in 1976 and more than six and a half decades of service to the business community and people of the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands since its founding in 1959.

- 1 **WHEREAS**, in late 1959, when Saipan’s population was still small, with
2 few roads, and an economy still emerging from the aftermath of the Second World
3 War, a group of visionary entrepreneurs came together in lateral Quonset huts at
4 the former Saipan and Royal Taga Hotels to form a loose association of businesses
5 dedicated to advancing commerce, opportunity, and prosperity for the people of
6 these islands; and
- 7 **WHEREAS**, the late Jose C. “Joeten” Tenorio served as the first President
8 of the Saipan Chamber of Commerce and, in that capacity, represented the interests
9 of the local business community during the political negotiation and transition
10 period from Trust Territory administration to Commonwealth status with the
11 United States of America; and

1 **WHEREAS**, the founding fathers of the Saipan Chamber of Commerce —
2 Dr. Manuel Aldan, Vicente Sablan, Santiago C. Tenorio, Manuel Pangelinan,
3 Manuel S. Villagomez, Herman Kintol, Elias P. Sablan, Jose C. Tenorio, George
4 Fleming, William S. Reyes, Juan Pangelinan, Frank Brown, David Sablan, Herman
5 Guerrero, Juan M. Ada, and Olympio T. Borja, planted the seeds of an enduring
6 institution whose vision and courage helped shape the modern economy of the
7 Northern Mariana Islands; and

8 **WHEREAS**, on the strength of that foundation, the Saipan Chamber of
9 Commerce was officially incorporated in 1976, two years before the islands became
10 an official Commonwealth of the United States, thereby institutionalizing an
11 independent, private-sector voice for enterprise, investment, and community well-
12 being in the CNMI; and

13 **WHEREAS**, the Saipan Chamber of Commerce is a non-profit
14 organization whose mission is to serve its members as a resource enhancing the
15 quality of business and life on Saipan; and

16 **WHEREAS**, the Saipan Chamber of Commerce is guided by the vision of
17 creating an island where businesses, family, and community succeed as one; and

18 **WHEREAS**, over the course of more than fifty years, the Chamber has
19 faithfully advanced that mission and vision by advocating for sound economic and
20 tax policy, championing tourism as a pillar of the Commonwealth's economy,
21 supporting workforce stabilization and labor policy, promoting utility reliability

1 and infrastructure investment, and engaging directly with the Legislature, the
2 Executive Branch, and federal partners on the most pressing issues facing the
3 CNMI; and

4 **WHEREAS**, the Chamber has grown into a diverse organization of
5 approximately 131 members ranging from sole-proprietors to large resort hotels,
6 service companies, tour agencies, insurance firms, banks, telecommunications
7 providers, and construction companies, reflecting the diversity of the people of the
8 Commonwealth; and

9 **WHEREAS**, through its signature programs — including the Business
10 Person of the Year Gala, the Chamber Scholarship Program, economic forums,
11 general membership meetings, and candidate forums- the Chamber has invested in
12 local youth, cultivated informed civic dialogue, and strengthened the connection
13 between the business community and the people it serves; and

14 **WHEREAS**, the Chamber has stood with the Commonwealth through
15 periods of remarkable growth and through profound challenges, including super
16 typhoons, the global pandemic, declining visitor arrivals, foreign currency
17 volatility, and airline capacity constraints, consistently offering practical,
18 responsible, and community-minded leadership; and

19 **WHEREAS**, under the current leadership of Board President Dr. Joshua
20 Wise, along with the Officers and Board of Directors, and the professional staff led

1 by Executive Director Kim C. Camacho, the Chamber continues to move the
2 community forward through enterprise; and

3 **WHEREAS**, in September 2026, the Saipan Chamber of Commerce will
4 celebrate its Golden Jubilee, a fitting occasion to recognize fifty years of formal
5 incorporated service, honor the memory of its founding fathers, and reaffirm the
6 enduring partnership between the private sector, the Legislature, and the people of
7 the Commonwealth; and

8 **WHEREAS**, the members of the House of Representatives of the Twenty-
9 Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth Legislature are proud to recognize the
10 Saipan Chamber of Commerce as an indispensable partner in building a stronger,
11 more resilient, and more prosperous Commonwealth; and

12 **NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED** by the House of
13 Representatives of the Twenty-Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth
14 Legislature that the House hereby congratulates, honors, and pays tribute to the
15 Saipan Chamber of Commerce on the occasion of its Golden Jubilee, and expresses
16 its profound gratitude to the Chamber's founding fathers, its past and present
17 Presidents, Officers, Boards of Directors, staff, and member businesses for more
18 than half a century of dedicated service to the business community and to the people
19 of the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands; and

20 **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that the House of Representatives
21 commends the Saipan Chamber of Commerce for its steadfast commitment to its

1 mission of serving its members as a resource enhancing the quality of business and
2 life on Saipan, and for its enduring vision of an island where businesses, family,
3 and community succeed as one; and

4 **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that the Sponsor of this Resolution, or the
5 designee of the Speaker of the House, shall present a certified original copy of this
6 Resolution to the Saipan Chamber of Commerce during its Golden Jubilee
7 celebration; and

8 **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that the Speaker of the House of
9 Representatives shall certify, and the House Clerk shall attest to the adoption of this
10 resolution and thereafter the House Clerk shall transmit a certified copy to Dr.
11 Joshua Wise, President of the Saipan Chamber of Commerce; Kim C. Camacho,
12 Executive Director of the Saipan Chamber of Commerce; the Honorable David M.
13 Apatang, Governor of the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands; the
14 Honorable Dennis C. Mendiola, Lieutenant Governor of the Commonwealth of the
15 Northern Mariana Islands; the Honorable Kimberlyn K. King-Hinds, CNMI
16 Delegate to the U.S. House of Representatives, 119th United States Congress; and
17 the Honorable Karl R. King-Nabors, Senate President of the Twenty-Fourth
18 Northern Marianas Commonwealth Legislature.

Prefiled: 9/11/2024

HOUSE RESOLUTION 24-31

Date: _____

Introduced by: _____

Rep. Edmund S. Villagomez

Reviewed for legal sufficiency by:

House Legal Counsel

Date: _____

9/4/26